

DIGILIANS

English Language Skills



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OPENING THE WORLD SINCE 1878



Discuss Cultural Stereotypes





Language Bank

perception – to discriminate against –
misconception – prejudice – to reinforce – bias – to
generalize – diverse



Activity 2: Fill in the blanks

perception – to discriminate against –
misconception – prejudice – to reinforce
– bias – to generalize – diverse

- 1- A common _____ is that older employees are not comfortable with new technology.
- 2- Media stereotypes can _____ negative ideas if they are repeated often.
- 3- It is unfair to _____ that a whole group of people behave a certain way based on one example.
- 4- Her _____ of the situation changed after she heard the other person's point of view.
- 5- The company was criticized for policies that seemed to _____ certain employees.
- 6- Personal _____ can affect how managers evaluate performance, even unintentionally.
- 7- Growing up in a _____ environment helps people develop stronger communication skills.
- 8- _____ can influence decisions before all the facts are known.



Activity 2: Answer Key

- 1- A common **misconception** is that older employees are not comfortable with new technology.
- 2- Media stereotypes can **reinforce** negative ideas if they are repeated often.
- 3- It is unfair to **generalize** that a whole group of people behave a certain way based on one example.
- 4- Her **perception** of the situation changed after she heard the other person's point of view.
- 5- The company was criticized for policies that seemed to **discriminate against** certain employees.
- 6- Personal **bias** can affect how managers evaluate performance, even unintentionally.
- 7- Growing up in a **diverse** environment helps people develop stronger communication skills.
- 8- **Prejudice** can influence decisions before all the facts are known.



Activity 1: Video Analysis

Note down the groups of people they used in their examples.





Activity 1: Video Analysis

- What are the different types of stereotypes mentioned in the video?
- What is the main difference between both?
- What happens when people are aware there is a stereotype against them?





Activity 1: Video Analysis (Answers)

- Explicit and implicit stereotypes.
- Explicit stereotypes are related to awareness; you know that you have this perception of a group of people, but implicit stereotypes are internalized, coming from your subconscious.
- They act out of fear and their performance worsens.





Activity 1: Video Analysis

Discuss: Can stereotypes be beneficial? How?
And how can we get rid of them?



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wY4rAN5HIAk>



Activity 3: Guess the Bias

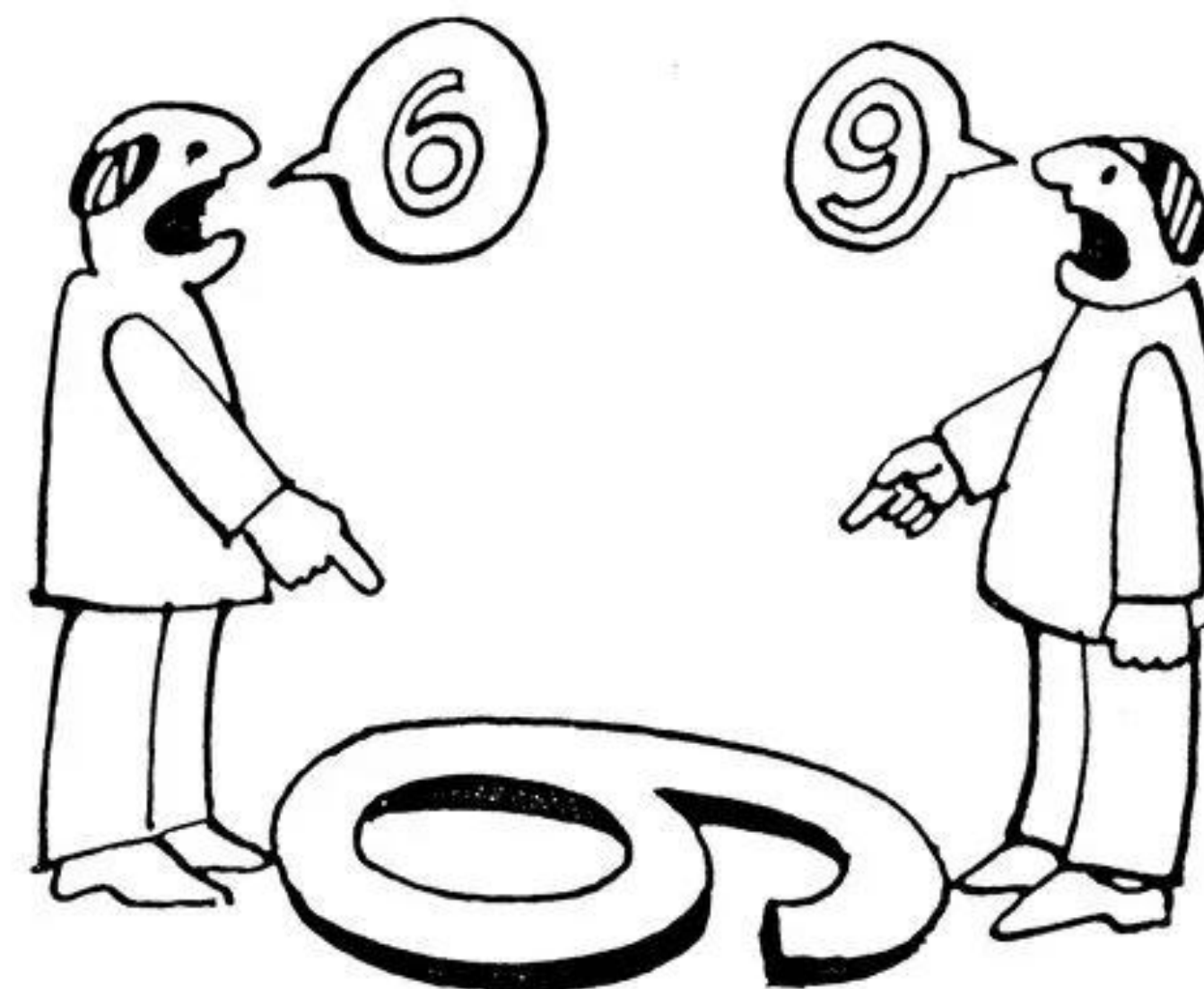
1. “She speaks with a strong accent, so clients might not understand her well.”
2. “He prefers to work alone, so he probably isn’t a team player.”
3. “They come from a very relaxed culture, so deadlines are not important to them.”
4. “She didn’t speak much in the meeting, so she must not have prepared.”
5. “He’s very young, so he won’t be ready to lead a team.”
6. “They ask a lot of questions, which means they don’t understand the task.”
7. “She’s very direct in emails, so she must be rude.”
8. “He works remotely, so he’s probably less committed than others.”
9. “They studied abroad, so they will definitely be more open-minded.”
10. “She’s very friendly, so she’s not serious about her work.”





Activity 4: Fact, Feeling, Assumption

1. “Our team includes employees from six different countries.”
2. “I feel uncomfortable when meetings are very informal.”
3. “People from that culture prefer indirect communication.”
4. “The project was delivered two days later than planned.”
5. “She seems less engaged because she doesn’t speak much in meetings.”
6. “I enjoy working in a multicultural team.”
7. “They probably didn’t reply because they don’t value quick responses.”
8. “The company hired three new international employees this year.”
9. “It’s frustrating when feedback is unclear.”
10. “He avoids eye contact because he isn’t confident.”





Activity 4: Answer Key

#	Category
1	Fact
2	Feeling
3	Assumption
4	Fact
5	Assumption
6	Feeling
7	Assumption
8	Fact
9	Feeling
10	Assumption



Activity 5: Debates



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Activity 5: Debates

1. “Stereotypes are created mostly by the media.”
2. “It is natural to make quick judgments about other cultures.”
3. “Positive stereotypes are still stereotypes.”
4. “Living abroad reduces cultural stereotypes.”
5. “Stereotypes make for healthy competition at the workplace.”
6. “Social media has made stereotypes stronger.”
7. “Personal experience is more powerful than facts in shaping stereotypes.”
8. “It’s impossible to completely avoid stereotypes.”
9. “Talking openly about stereotypes makes situations better.”
10. “Cultural stereotypes affect communication more than language mistakes.”



Activity 6: Speed Cultural Talk



Activity 6: Speed Cultural Talk

1. A cultural stereotype about your country that is completely wrong.
2. A cultural habit that visitors often misunderstand.
3. A time when a stereotype influenced your first impression of someone.
4. A positive cultural difference you noticed when traveling or working abroad.
5. A stereotype that sounds positive but feels uncomfortable.
6. A cultural rule that surprised you when you first learned it.
7. A workplace behavior that could easily be misunderstood in another culture.
8. A time when you realized your perception of a culture was incomplete.
9. A stereotype you used to believe but later questioned.
10. A cultural value that people often oversimplify.
11. A tradition that outsiders often judge without understanding.
12. A situation where silence or indirect communication caused confusion.
13. A cultural habit that makes teamwork easier.
14. A moment when media influenced your opinion about a culture.
15. A cultural difference that people exaggerate too much.
16. A stereotype that affects professional relationships.
17. A time when asking questions helped avoid a cultural misunderstanding.
18. A cultural behavior that seems strange at first but makes sense later.
19. A stereotype you hear often in movies or TV shows.
20. A cultural habit you appreciate more now than before.

Error Correction